Walmart

Traditional departments organize the store. In everyday grocery, Great Value and bettergoods provide the clearest value-to-elevation choice; fresh food uses dedicated brands, while Equate belongs to Walmart's broader health-and-beauty world.

Walmart
Save money. Live better.™

HOW SHOPPERS NAVIGATE THE STORE

Grocery & Packaged Foods | Fresh & Deli | Beverages | Pharmacy & Health | Beauty & Personal Care

Walmart is organized by familiar departments. Private labels are not used to reorganize the store — they differentiate the proposition within each category.

REGULAR GROCERY

Two price / proposition tiers across categories

Great Value

Everyday value and trusted quality

- ✓ Broadest range across grocery categories
- ✓ Familiar, category-native benefits (e.g. protein, wholegrain, reduction)
- ✓ Accessible everyday prices



Great Value
Zero Sugar Beef Jerky

bettergoods

Accaccessible elevation and discovery

- ✓ More differentiated recipes and ingredients
- ✓ Often multi-benefit positioning (e.g. protein, fibre, plant-based)
- ✓ Modern and lifestyle-oriented



bettergoods
Plant-Based Almond Milk

FRESH & DELI

Dedicated brands for fresh food

Marketside

Fresh, convenient meals and deli solutions

- ✓ Fresh foods (produce, deli, ready-to-eat meals)
- ✓ Quality, freshness and convenience
- ✓ Wide range across fresh categories



Marketside
Ready-to-Heat Meal

Freshness Guaranteed

Everyday fresh at a great value

- ✓ Fresh produce, bakery and perishables
- ✓ Simple and clear positioning
- ✓ Quality and freshness you can trust



Freshness Guaranteed
Gala Apples

BEVERAGES

Category-specific brand

CLEAR AMERICAN

Refreshing variety at great value

- ✓ Beverage-focused brand
- ✓ Flavoured sparkling water and functional drinks
- ✓ Lives in the beverage aisle (like other beverage brands)



Clear American
Black Cherry Sparkling Water

PHARMACY, HEALTH & BEAUTY

A broader Walmart umbrella brand

equate™

Everyday health and personal care essentials

- ✓ Covers Pharmacy, Health and Beauty across the store
- ✓ Protein shakes sold in the OTC / Pharmacy aisle
- ✓ Also includes skincare, first aid, personal care and many non-food items



Equate Max Protein
Protein Shake

CATEGORY SETS THE SHOPPING PATH. WITHIN EVERYDAY GROCERY, GREAT VALUE → BETTERGOODS MOVES FROM DEFAULT VALUE TO ACCESSIBLE ELEVATION.

Note: Sam's Choice remains in the portfolio but is not a core part of the current architecture. Clear American is a beverage-specific brand and not a separate tier. Equate covers Pharmacy, Health and Beauty beyond food.

Kroger

Smart Way → Kroger → Private Selection forms the core value-to-premium ladder. Simple Truth spans normal grocery categories with Organic, Plant-Based / Free From and Protein propositions.

CORE PRICE / QUALITY LADDER

From everyday value to elevated quality, across all categories.

VALUE / ENTRY

smart way

Opening-price essentials

- Lowest-price staples
- Opening-price tier
- Price structures the ladder

EVERYDAY CORE

Kroger

Default brand across categories

- Function stays mostly category-native
- Daily → protein / reduction / free-from
- Benefits reinforce the food rather than redefine it.

Other named branches: CARBmaster · Mercado · Big K

PREMIUM

PRIVATE SELECTION

Culinary quality proposition

- Taste / ingredients / provenance
- Elevated food experience
- **Premium quality is the proposition.**

SIMPLE TRUTH WELLNESS LAYER

Simple Truth serves specific wellness needs and values, across grocery aisles.

simple truth

Wellness and values create propositions across categories.

Free-from logic makes the proposition broader than just organic.

Organic

- Organic / plant-based / free-from
- A values-led choice

Plant-Based / Free From

- Supports specific diets and lifestyles
- Extends beyond organic

Protein

- Protein has become a cross-category platform
- Extends from everyday food toward performance

Simple Truth travels across grocery aisles; it is not sold in a separate wellness section.
Specialist powders extend into sports nutrition.

PRICE / QUALITY LADDER – EXAMPLE PRODUCTS

SMART WAY (VALUE / ENTRY)



Smart Way
Iced Oatmeal Cookies

KROGER (EVERYDAY CORE)



Kroger Protein
Chewy Bars

PRIVATE SELECTION (PREMIUM)



Private Selection
72% Cacao Swiss Bar

SIMPLE TRUTH WELLNESS LAYER - EXAMPLE PRODUCTS

ORGANIC



Simple Truth Organic
Kombucha

PLANT-BASED / FREE FROM



Simple Truth Plant Based
Cookie Dough

PROTEIN (CROSS-CATEGORY)



Simple Truth Protein

CATEGORY-BOUND FUNCTION (SUPPORTING EXAMPLE)



Kroger CARBmaster
Protein Smoothie

CE / QUALITY STRUCTURES THE CORE. SIMPLE TRUTH ADDS A CROSS-CATEGORY WELLNESS LAYER. PROTEIN IS ITS MOST DEVELOPED FUNCTIONAL BRAN

CARBmaster, Mercado and Big K are meaningful named branches, but they do not define Kroger's primary architecture.

Target

Market Pantry covers affordable family basics, Good & Gather is the flagship food brand with Organic and Signature extensions. Favorite Day owns indulgence and occasion; up&up sits separately in specialist nutrition.

CORE PRICE / QUALITY LADDER

From everyday value to elevated quality, across all categories.

VALUE / ENTRY

MARKET PANTRY®

Affordable family basics

- Family favorites for less
- Opening-price tier
- Food first, benefit second

Value is kept simple and familiar.

EVERYDAY FLAGSHIP

Good & Gather™

Flagship food brand across categories

- High baseline standards
- Ingredient reassurance is built in
- Function stays mostly category-native

ORGANIC EXTENSION

- Values / certification
- Organic, free-from and natural cues

SIGNATURE EXTENSION

- Premium / culinary elevation
- Origin, craft and discovery

Target absorbs wellness and premium inside the flagship.

INDULGENCE / OCCASION

favorite day®

Treats and special moments

- Desserts, bakery and snacks
- Celebration / sharing / indulgence
- Function is not the proposition

Occasion becomes architecture.

SPECIALIST NUTRITION ADJACENCY

up&up™

Separate from core food architecture

- Protein and performance products
- Powders, bars and functional snacks
- More explicit function than core grocery

Specialist nutrition sits alongside food; products are sold in relevant nutrition or category aisles, not in a separate permanent up&up food section.

Target keeps the architecture simple: value, flagship quality and indulgence structure food, while up&up holds specialist function separately.

MARKET PANTRY (value)



Market Pantry
White Sandwich Bread

GOOD & GATHER (everyday flagship)



Good & Gather
Ultra-Filtered Milk



Good & Gather Organic
Blue Corn Tortilla Chips



Good & Gather Signature
Organic Ethiopia Yirgacheffe Coffee

FAVORITE DAY (indulgence)



Favorite Day
Macarons Assortment

up&up (specialist nutrition)



up&up
Tortilla-Style Protein Chips



up&up
Whey Protein Powder

SIMPLE ROLES ORGANIZE THE FOOD PORTFOLIO. GOOD & GATHER CARRIES THE HIGHEST BASELINE. up&up HOLDS SPECIALIST FUNCTION APART.

Walgreens

Nice! covers everyday convenience and value. Nice! For You keeps the same cross-category role but adds a defined better-for-you specification and more explicit benefit layering.

Walgreens
A HEALTHIER HAPPIER TOMORROW™

EVERYDAY VALUE / CORE

nice! SIMPLE · HONEST DELICIOUS™

Everyday value + acceptable quality

- Familiar food across core categories
- Popular, scalable benefits where they make sense
- Protein · reduction · fibre / wholegrain · heart-health cues
- Food first, benefit second

Mainstream benefits can scale without creating a new wellness world.

Same cross-category role → stronger specification

BETTER-FOR-YOU STEP-UP

nice! SIMPLE · HONEST FOR YOU™

Everyday value + defined better-for-you specification

BASELINE GATE

- No artificial flavors
- No artificial sweeteners
- No synthetic dyes
- No HFCS

THEN ADD CATEGORY-RELEVANT BENEFITS

- Organic
- Protein
- Fibre
- Free-from / dietary cues
- Non-GMO / ingredient reassurance

More sophisticated benefit layering – without changing the shopping mission.

Nice! and Nice! For You sit in the normal grocery/snack categories; Nice! For You is a tier, not a separate wellness aisle.

Walgreens compresses the same shopper logic seen at larger retailers: the core scales familiar benefits; the step-up bundles a clearer better-for-you promise.

NICE! CORE



Nice!
Cinnamon Squares



Nice!
Maple & Brown Sugar
Instant Oatmeal

NICE! FOR YOU



Nice! For You
Quick Oats



Nice! For You
Protein Granola Oats & Honey



Nice! For You
Organic Tart Cherry Juice



Nice! For You
Roasted Whole Almonds

THE CORE SCALES FAMILIAR BENEFITS. THE STEP-UP ADDS A QUALIFICATION GATE — THEN LAYERS MORE SOPHISTICATED BENEFITS.

OFF under-captures Nice! For You, current Walgreens evidence shows the tier spans multiple grocery categories.

Costco

Kirkland Signature is Costco's only major private label, spanning everyday staples, values / wellness, quality / provenance and function / performance without separate food sub-brands.

ONE PRIVATE LABEL ACROSS THE WAREHOUSE

No separate food brands or sub-ranges identified

KIRKLAND Signature®

- Single cross-category Costco private label
- Bulk formats and strong value-for-quality baseline
- When the proposition changes, the brand does not

EVERYDAY / CORE

- Staples, pantry basics and bulk everyday formats
- Default Kirkland proposition
- The base from which other product worlds extend

Costco keeps the architecture simple

VALUES / WELLNESS

- Organic, plant-based, dairy-free and cleaner propositions
- Whole grains, probiotics and broader wellness cues
- Wellness lives inside Kirkland, not in a separate brand

Values and wellness become product propositions

QUALITY / PROVENANCE

- Grass-fed, origin and specialist ingredients
- Premium food cues without a premium sub-brand
- Quality and sourcing are communicated product by product

Premium cues stay inside the same brand

FUNCTION / PERFORMANCE

- Protein, fibre, hydration, energy and sports nutrition
- Even specialist performance stays under Kirkland Signature
- No separate performance private label needed

Function becomes a product world, not a new brand

At Costco, the product proposition changes — the brand does not. Kirkland Signature stretches into new needs instead of creating new food brands.

EXAMPLES ACROSS THE PRODUCT WORLDS

VALUES / WELLNESS



Organic Soy Beverage



Ancient Grains Probiotic Granola

QUALITY / PROVENANCE



Grass-Fed Butter



Spanish Manchego

FUNCTION / PERFORMANCE



Protein Bars



Whey Protein



Sparkling Energy Drink

ONE BRAND COVERS THE WAREHOUSE. DIFFERENT NEEDS CREATE DIFFERENT PRODUCT WORLDS — NOT DIFFERENT PRIVATE LABELS.

US Private Label vs US Market Median: Protein

Across cereals, snacks and beverages, retailer private-label portfolios are broadly market-like. Dairy is the main exception, and the spread looks largely assortment-driven; hard / semi-hard cheese and butter exposure shifts protein, fat and energy medians more than portfolio-wide reformulation does.

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

Median protein by category

All values are medians in g/100 g or ml.

Retailer	Dairy	Cereals	Snacks	Beverages
US median	**6.9**	**9.1**	**6.9**	**0.0**
Walmart	8.2	8.9	5.9	0.0
Kroger	5.3	9.8	7.1	0.0
Target	14.3	8.8	6.7	0.0
Walgreens	—	9.3	6.7	0.0
Costco	4.0	10.4	7.1	0.0

Private Labels vs Market medians

1. Cereals are close to the regional median across all five retailers; Costco is modestly higher.
2. Snacks are also broadly market-like; Walmart is the clearest slightly-below-market case.
3. Dairy shows the widest spread, and the pattern is largely explained by assortment mix rather than portfolio-wide protein reformulation.

Why dairy differs*

Retailer	Protein g/100 g	Fat g/100 g	Energy kcal/100 g	Reugh hard cheese + butter share
US median	6.9	2.3	92	—
Walmart	8.2	8.1	155	~39%
Kroger	5.3	1.0	80	~25%
Target	14.3	11.5	263	~54%
Costco	4.0	3.8	250	~40%

Hard cheese lifts protein, fat and energy together; butter lifts fat and energy without lifting protein. This explains most of the dairy spread. Walgreens dairy sample is too sparse to interpret.

Main message: US private label is broadly market-like on protein outside dairy; dairy differences are largely assortment effects linked to hard cheese and butter mix.

* Dairy is highly mix-sensitive. Shares are rough name-based checks of hard / semi-hard cheese and butter rows. Use as directional evidence, not precise assortment measurement.

US Private Label vs US Market Median: Fibre

Most private-label portfolios remain close to the regional fibre median. Costco cereals are the clearest positistive outlier, while Walgreens is too sparse to interpret confidently in some categories.

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS **BRIGHTER TOMORROWS**

Median fibre by category

All values are medians in g/100 g or ml.

Retailer	Dairy	Cereals	Snacks	Beverages
US median	**0.0**	**7.1**	**3.6**	**0.0**
Walmart	0.0	7.4	2.7	0.0
Kroger	0.0	6.9	3.1	0.0
Target	0.0	7.2	3.0	0.0
Walgreens	—	7.0	2.3	0.0
Costco	0.0	10.9	3.3	0.0

Private Labels vs Market medians

1. Cereals are mostly market-like; Costco is the clearest positive outlier.
2. For Walmart, Kroger and Target, snacks remain broadly similar to the regional median.
3. Walgreens snacks are too sparse to interpret, and Costco's cereal uplift reflects a tiny measured sample dominated by oats and whole-grain / ancient-grain granola.

Why Costco cereals look higher*

Measured Costco cereal product	Fibre g/100 g
Whole Grain Rolled Oats	10.0
Ancient Grains Granola with Almonds	10.9
Ancient Grains Organic Granola	11.3

Only three Costco cereal rows carry fibre values. The apparent advantage is a small-sample assortment effect: the measured products are oats and whole-grain / ancient-grain granola, not a broad cereal portfolio. Walgreens snacks have only a handful of fibre-coded rows and are not robust enough to interpret.

Main message: US private label is mostly market-like on fibre; Costco cereals look higher because the tiny measured sample is concentrated in oats and whole-grain granola.

* Broad portfolio comparison; treat as directional. Walgreens snack fibre coverage is sparse. Costco cereal fibre is based on only three measured products. Source: Open Food Facts-based retailer pulls and US category benchmarks.

What do claim-bearing private-label packs communicate?

US mainstream private label leans more into organic / natural and better-for-you reduction cues than origin storytelling. Protein matters, but it is not universally dominant on pack.

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

Among packs with at least one detected on-pack claim, % carrying each benefit territory. One pack can carry several territories, so columns do not sum to 100%. Top row shows claim incidence among all OCR/LLM-analyzed packs.

BENEFIT TERRITORY	WALMART	KROGER	TARGET	WALGREENS	COSTCO
Packs with ≥1 detected on-pack claim	**33%**	**60%**	**38%**	**18%***	**56%**
QUALITY / VALUES / ORIGIN					
Organic / natural	29%	**55%**	45%	14%	**64%**
Origin / provenance / quality	1%	2%	0%	0%	**13%**
Clean label / no-additives	16%	11%	**29%**	14%	11%
Plant-based / vegan	2%	7%	4%	0%	**16%**
Sustainability	**1%**	0%	0%	0%	0%
FUNCTIONAL — ADD / SUPPORT					
Protein	12%	10%	4%	14%	**20%**
Fibre / wholegrain	13%	10%	10%	**43%**	4%
Fortification	20%	16%	10%	0%	**29%**
Energy	**1%**	0%	0%	0%	0%
Gut health	2%	**3%**	0%	0%	0%
Immune	**2%**	0%	1%	0%	**2%**
FUNCTIONAL — REDUCE / REMOVE					
Sugar / fat reduction	**27%**	23%	16%	**43%**	22%
Free-from (gluten / lactose / dairy)	13%	24%	17%	14%	**42%**

US claim-bearing private-label packs skew toward organic / natural and better-for-you reduction cues; protein is important, but not the universal lead story.

Food & Beverage Positioning Radar • US mainstream retailers • OCR/LLM-detected on-pack positioning • claim incidence row = all analyzed packs; benefit rows = claim-bearing packs only. *Walgreens is directional only: 40 packs were OCR/LLM-analyzed and just 7 were claim-bearing.

US private labels: structured portfolios, selective communicators

They are built around how shoppers navigate the store — by category, price tier, occasion and wellness need — more than around a single nutrient story. That makes them structurally diverse and less uniformly vocal than UK private label.

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

1. THE PRODUCT ITSELF

Mostly market-like composition

- Protein and fibre stay close to US category medians in cereals, snacks and beverages
- Dairy differences are mostly mix effects linked to hard cheese and butter
- Portfolio-wide reformulation is not the main story

Market-like composition

2. THE PORTFOLIO

Architecture varies by retailer

- Walmart and Target stay category-led, with price / quality tiers inside core grocery
- Kroger adds a dedicated wellness layer via Simple Truth
- Costco stretches one brand across product worlds; Walgreens compresses the logic into a two-level promise

Multiple organizing logics

3. THE TREND STRATEGY

Different routes to the same needs

- Organic / natural, reduction, free-from and protein all matter
- Function can appear as a layer, an adjacency or a product world
- US retailers adapt the same needs through different brand architectures rather than one common template

Different routes to scale

4. THE COMMUNICATION

Selective, not uniformly vocal

- Claim intensity varies widely by retailer — from 33% to 60%*
- Claims skew toward organic / natural and better-for-you reduction cues
- Protein matters, but it is not the universal lead story on pack

Selective claim communication

*Walgreens excluded due to small sample

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

Architecture matters as much as the claim.

If the private-label product stays broadly market-like in composition, the retailer can still differentiate by giving it a clear store role: value tier, flagship, wellness layer, occasion brand or specialist adjacency.

“In the US, architecture does more of the work; claims finish the story.”

US private label does not follow one single formula. It keeps composition broadly market-like, organizes demand through retailer-specific architectures and communicates benefits more selectively than the UK.